Reed College Informed Consent to Participate in Research
Transfeminine Interactional Styles and Experiences
Speaker (Transfeminine)
Spring 2026

Summary

This study is a senior thesis conducted at Reed College by Wren Arbor. I am studying transfeminine people's interactional styles. You will be asked to participate in 3 one-on-one audio-recorded conversation sessions with Reed students conducted on Reed campus, and to fill out a survey. One of the recording sessions will be a conversation with me. In each of the other two, you and one fellow Reed student, your co-participant, will be asked to collaboratively play word game, and then briefly get to know each other. I will not begin or end audio-recordings without your knowledge. The study will primarily focus on certain measures of your voice, with reference to context about your transgender identity and experience. You will be referred to solely under a pseudonym, and measures will be taken in order to keep your identity, and information you share but do not authorize me to share even under association only with your pseudonym, confidential. Each of the conversations will last approximately 20 to 30 minutes, and the survey will take approximately 10 to 15 minutes. In total, your participation will require approximately 1 hour and 30 minutes. You will earn $30 for your time. If successful, this study may contribute to our understandings of gender, the transgender experience, sexuality, language, and interaction.

Consent and Withdrawal

Your participation in this study is entirely voluntary. You may choose not to answer individual questions or engage in individual activities. You are free to talk with me about alternative methods of participation. You may discontinue all participation in this study at any time without losing the $30 incentive. If you choose to withdraw from the study at any time, all data collected from you will be destroyed and will not appear in my thesis or any future publications. However, after the finalization of my thesis (May 14, 2025), or, in the case that you provide consent to be included in any of my future publications and only withdraw from the study after the finalization of those publications, any released data may not be able to be retracted.

Risks

- It is possible that your speech or your survey responses may contain **details which may inadvertently reveal your identity** if shared.
- Although I will discourage them from doing so, **it is possible your co-participants will share information about you with others**.
- You may experience **discomfort due to sensitivity of survey and conversation questions** which will ask you to discuss personal topics with regard to your identity and experiences, including transphobia. All questions are optional and mental health resources will be provided if emotional distress is caused.
- Despite secure data-storage practices, there is always the low probability of a **data breach**.

Participation Details

The **number of visits needed will be at most 2**, depending on scheduling constraints. Your participation will take place on Reed campus in the **Lab of Linguistics (Eliot 101D)**. The order of activities will be:

1. orientation,
2. recording sessions with ~10 min breaks in between,
3. survey, and
4. debrief (if necessary).

Data Storage and Confidentiality

You will be referred to using a pseudonym of your choice. This pseudonym will be used to refer to you in all published materials. Your name, your email address, and your consent form, the information linking your name to your pseudonym, and your name to your email address will be kept confidential and stored securely in a password-protected folder which will be deleted by May 14, 2026.

A separate secure folder, protected by a different password, will be used to store audio recordings, transcripts, and survey responses. Names, as well as any other information you select, will be deleted from transcripts, audio recordings, and survey responses before storage. I will only store audio recordings, transcripts, and survey responses under your pseudonym. This folder may be shared with my thesis advisor, who will not share any information in it further and will store it under the same encrypted password-protection.

If additional consent is provided, I may additionally upload audio recordings to an online service called DARLA which will perform machine transcription. DARLA deletes data after processing and "will not use your data or [the researcher's] email address for any other purpose" (http://darla.dartmouth.edu/about#privacy). There is additionally the option for DARLA to use the Deepgram enhanced speech model to automate the first step of its process, which would otherwise be performed by me. Deepgram "maintains the right to hold records of uploaded audio data but will not use it for any purpose without permission from the audio owner", and will "only process [the audio data] on behalf and under the instruction of [the audio owner]" (https://deepgram.com/privacy). In this case, the audio owner will be myself. I will not provide permission for any use of the uploaded audio data other than the automated machine-transcription I uploaded it for. Personal names will not be in the version of the recordings uploaded, and the recordings uploaded will not be labeled with your name or any other identifying information.

If you would like me to use DARLA but not Deepgram, this is also possible. In this case, the first step of transcription which would have been performed by Deepgram would instead be performed manually, and then passed to DARLA.

If you do not consent to the use of these online tools, you will still be included in analysis, and will still recieve the monetary incentive associated with the study. In that case, I will manually transcribe your recordings locally on my computer, and will not upload the recordings to the internet, except inside of the encrypted and password protected folder containing recordings, survey responses, and transcripts which will be backed up to my private Reed College Google Drive.

I will not report or publish audio recordings, as someone may be able to identify you solely from the sound of your voice. You may opt for audio recordings:

(a) to be deleted once this study is completed (May 14, 2026),
(b) to be stored indefinitely for use in any future research I conduct. In this case, you also can opt to allow me to share audio recordings with any future research collaborators who will not share them further and will store them under the same encrypted password-protection.

My thesis advisor and any further research collaborators will delete their copies of the data once our collaboration is finished. Survey responses and transcripts of your speech may also have identifiability risks depending on the personal details you choose to include. I will encourage you to refrain from sharing identifiable information, and you may change your survey responses and ask for any details you share in interviews to remain confidential after the fact.

I will report, under your pseudonym, that you are a Reed College student above the age of 18 and 25 who identifies with the label "transfeminine", numerical measures of your speech, and your survey responses. If you provide consent for me to freely quote, excerpt, or paraphrase the content of transcripts I may also do so (under your pseudonym). My thesis advisor and collaborators will not be permitted to do so in publications of which I am not co-author.

I will be glad to answer any questions or concerns you may have about this study. Answers to questions on topics that might influence the outcome of the study may be deferred until study activities have ended, when I will explain the purpose of the study in more detail. I can be reached at dylanking@reed.edu or 425-260-4232.

Concerns about any aspect of this project may also be addressed to my thesis advisor, Professor Allison Casar (acasar@reed.edu), or to the Chair of the Reed College Institutional Review Board Prof Luda Korobenko (korobenko@reed.edu, 503-517-4901).

_____
Name

I voluntarily consent to participate in this study. By signing below, I certify that I am 18 years of age or older. I will be given a copy of this consent form.

_____ _____
Signature *Date*

I agree to the audio recording and transcription of my speech during the conversations involved in this study.

_____ _____
Signature *Date*

I agree to the indefinite storage and possible use of audio recordings, transcripts, and survey responses in future research.

_____ _____

Signature *Date*

If I agreed to the above, additionally I agree to the sharing of audio recordings, transcripts, and survey responses with future research collaborators, provided they agree to uphold the same standards of confidentiality.

_____ _____

Signature *Date*

I agree to complete a survey pertaining to aspects of my identity and experience.

_____ _____

Signature *Date*

I agree to quotation, excerpting, and paraphrasing of the content of my speech during recording sessions.

_____ _____

Signature *Date*

I agree to recordings of my voice being uploaded to DARLA, but not Deepgram, in the manner described above.

_____ _____

Signature *Date*

I agree to recordings of my voice being uploaded to DARLA and Deepgram in the manner described above.

_____ _____

Signature *Date*